Swedish radio announced the asylum offer that evening, and over the next two months, the Danish resistance and Swedish coast guard arranged passage for hundreds of small fishing boats, rowboats, and canoes, each boat ferrying two, three, four Jewish Danes to safety. More than 7,000 Jews—95 percent of the Jews that lived in Denmark at the time—managed to evade the Nazis.

Stockholm, crawling with Nazi agents, wasn't safe for Bohr—and the Allies decided that Bohr himself was too important to remain in Sweden anyhow. The British Royal Air Force dispatched a high-altitude Mosquito bomber, a small plane designed to fly higher than antiaircraft fire, to bring Bohr to the UK. The small aircraft's bomb bay was specially equipped to carry Bohr, with an oxygen mask and a pair of headphones to allow the pilot to communicate with his precious cargo. But the headphones were too small for Bohr's enormous head. Unable to hear the command to turn on his oxygen, Bohr passed out. The pilot realized there was a problem and flew the plane low over the North Sea; Bohr survived. After a briefing in England, Bohr flew to the United States, where he was whisked to the headquarters of the Manhattan Project in Los Alamos, traveling under the alias Nicholas Baker. Guiding "Nicholas" around the facilities, Teller was looking forward to showing Bohr that his pessimism about nuclear power had been misguided. "But before I could open my mouth, [Bohr] said, 'You see, I told you it couldn't be done without turning the whole country into a factory. You have done just that.'"

Bohr was more right than he knew. By the end of the war, the Manhattan Project had cost the nation nearly $25 billion, employing 125,000 people at thirty-one different locations across the United States and Canada. Hundreds of physicists were called away from their everyday laboratory work to satisfy Manhattan's relentless hunger for people and materials. After the war ended, physics research in the United States never returned to what it was before the war. Damned by their success in building the bomb, military research dollars poured into physics. In 1938, before the war, total spending on physics research in the United States was about $17 million, and nearly none of it came from the government. Less than a decade after the war, in 1953, physics research funding was just shy of $400 million—an increase by a factor of twenty-five in just fifteen years. And, by 1954, 98 percent of the money for basic research in the physical sciences in the